ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

# THA 252: Fundamentals of Radio, TV and Film Production

Plan, shoot and edit a short production with the equipment you actually have

THEATRE & FILM

## Theatre & Film Studies

Faculty of Arts
Theatre & Film Studies | 200L

OUTLINE ARCHIVE: 2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

**Written for students, by students.**

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

**Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.**

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

# Why this pack exists

This pack is a production manual for students with limited equipment: a phone, a borrowed camera and free editing software. It covers formats and durations, scripting for radio and screen, shooting coverage, sound capture, editing workflow and delivery formats.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

## What you will be able to do

- Write a production proposal with format, audience, duration and budget.
- Record clean sound and shoot usable coverage on limited equipment.
- Edit a short sequence with continuity and a coherent mix.
- Export and deliver in the required broadcast or online format.

## How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

## Formats and scripts

Different media demand different scripts.

- Radio drama: sound-only storytelling; write for ears, not eyes.
- Radio magazine or news: timing, cue and actuality inserts.
- Television: visual continuity, presenter links and package structure.
- Short film: visual storytelling with economy; fewer locations, stronger scenes.
- Documentary: research, contributor access, ethics and release forms.
- Always write to a duration you can actually fill.

## Production on limited equipment

Technique beats gear at student level.

- Lock exposure and focus manually where possible; autofocus hunts in low light.
- Record sound close to the source; a cheap lavalier beats a distant camera mic.
- Shoot coverage: wide, medium, close and cutaways for every scene.
- Observe the 180-degree rule and keep screen direction consistent.
- Use available light thoughtfully; bounce and diffuse before adding fixtures.
- Log every take with scene, shot and notes.

> **Sound first**
> Audiences forgive soft images but not unusable audio. Capture clean dialogue and wild track before you chase a prettier shot.

## Post-production and delivery

Editing is where the story is actually built.

- Organise footage by scene and take before editing.
- Assemble a rough cut for story, then refine rhythm.
- Keep audio levels consistent; avoid clipping.
- Add music only where licensed or original.
- Colour-correct for consistency rather than spectacle.
- Export to the required codec, resolution and duration; check playback on a phone.

OUTLINE ARCHIVE

# Session record: THA 252

*2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026*

Year demarcation matters: a course code that existed in 2018 may have been renumbered, merged or dropped by 2019, and the department now also runs a film track. Read the year label before you rely on a code. The current entry below is a compiled map - take it to your course rep or the departmental office and confirm it before registration.

## 2018 — Archived course description — ARCHIVED

- THA 252 Fundamentals of Radio, Television and Film Production
- Electronic media designs, audio-visual production styles for radio, television, filmic rendition and documentary
- Use of media, equipment and studio environments emphasised

Source: unizik.edu.ng - Theatre & Film Studies course description (page dated 31 May 2018; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

## 2019 — Archived programme listing — ARCHIVED

- THA 252 Fundamentals of Radio, TV and Film Production, 3 credits, second semester, 200 level
- THA 324 Techniques of Radio, TV and Film Directing and Production follows at 300 level
- THA 333 Jingle and Effects Design for Radio and Television also listed

*What changed: The 2019 listing separates production fundamentals (252) from directing (324) and effects design (333).*

Source: arts.unizik.edu.ng - Theatre Arts programme and course map (page dated 18 Oct 2019; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

## 2025/2026 — Compiled working map — CURRENT WORKING MAP

- Production fundamentals remains the 200-level media core
- Expect a submitted production artefact, not only a written exam
- Confirm equipment booking rules and whether you may shoot on a phone

Source: Compiled by ZikShare from the archived 2018 and 2019 departmental pages plus the published stress areas; this is a working map, not an official handout (retrieved 2026-10-22)

*Archive means: this records what a public departmental page listed in that year. It is not a guarantee of the current curriculum, and ZikShare is not affiliated with UNIZIK.*

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

## Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Why is a lavalier microphone usually better than a camera microphone?

Answer: It sits close to the speaker, capturing clearer dialogue and rejecting more room noise.

2. What coverage should you shoot for each scene?

Answer: A wide master, mediums, close-ups and cutaways, so the edit has choices.

3. What is wild track?

Answer: Audio recorded separately from picture, such as room tone or effects, used to build the soundtrack.

4. Why export and test on a phone?

Answer: Most viewers watch on mobile, and phone playback reveals level, framing and legibility problems.

5. Name two documentary ethics requirements.

Answer: Informed consent from contributors and accurate representation; release forms and protection of vulnerable subjects also apply.

## Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Write a one-page production proposal.
- [ ] Script a three-minute radio piece and a three-minute screen scene.
- [ ] Shoot coverage for one scene with logged takes.
- [ ] Record clean dialogue and room tone.
- [ ] Edit a rough cut and a fine cut.
- [ ] Mix audio and check levels on headphones and phone speaker.
- [ ] Export and screen it for feedback.

## Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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*ZikShare Academic Vault | Theatre & Film Studies | 200L | 2026 Fresher Edition*

YOUR WORKSPACE

# Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

**Three ideas I can now explain without notes:**

**A question I still cannot answer:**

**For my lecturer or course rep:**

**Next revision action and date:**

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